

- 99.** Her secret to peace, health and joy is keeping a balance in everything.
 (a) secrets to (b) secret of
 (c) secreted to (d) No improvement
- 100.** There are not many takers on the newly launched scooter.
 (a) takers of (b) taker of
 (c) takers off (d) No improvement
- 101.** I saw a parliament of owls in the jungle.
 (a) flock of owls
 (b) herd of owls
 (c) retinue of owls
 (d) No improvement
- 102.** The actor has played contrast characters in the two films.
 (a) contrasted characters
 (b) contrasting character
 (c) contrasting characters
 (d) No improvement
- 103.** Nupur has been living in Janakpuri for 1988.
 (a) since
 (b) from
 (c) of
 (d) No improvement
- 104.** The humming bird is smaller than any bird in the world.
 (a) any others bird
 (b) any other bird
 (c) any other birds
 (d) No improvement
- 105.** Let's make the world a safest place to live in.
 (a) a safety place
 (b) a safer places
 (c) a safer place
 (d) No improvement
- 106.** I saw a bevy of beauties in the fashion show.
 (a) group of beauties
 (b) clan of beauties
 (c) swarm of beauties
 (d) No improvement
- 107.** It takes skilled negotiations to pull on a deal like that.
 (a) pull of (b) pull off
 (c) pull at (d) No improvement
- 108.** The customer cared professional met with an accident.
 (a) customer care professionals
 (b) customer cares professional
 (c) customer care professional
 (d) No improvement
- 109.** It's the sort of work that calls for a high level of concentration.
 (a) call for (b) calls from
 (c) calls off (d) No improvement
- 110.** Rockon-2 is a much watch movie for everyone.
 (a) much watched (b) more watch
 (c) must watch (d) No improvement

QUESTIONS FROM **CDS EXAM (2012-2016)**

Directions (Q. Nos.1-139) Select the option which improves the **underlined** part of the sentences. In case, there is no improvement, choose option (d).

2012 (II)

- 1.** More than one person was killed in the accident.
 (a) were killed
 (b) are killed
 (c) have been killed
 (d) No improvement
- 2.** Not a word they spoke to the unfortunate wife about it.
 (a) did they speak
 (b) they will speak
 (c) they had spoken
 (d) No improvement
- 3.** The poor villagers have waited in bitter cold for more than four hours now.
 (a) have been waiting
 (b) had waited
 (c) has been waiting
 (d) No improvement
- 4.** If he had time he will call you.
 (a) would have
 (b) would have had
 (c) has
 (d) No improvement
- 5.** All, but her, had made an attempt.
 (a) All, but she
 (b) All but her
 (c) All, but her
 (d) No improvement
- 6.** I am used to hard work.
 (a) work hard
 (b) work hardly
 (c) hard working
 (d) No improvement
- 7.** Twenty kilometres are not a great distance in these days of fast moving vehicles.
 (a) is not a great distance
 (b) is no distance
 (c) aren't a great distance
 (d) No improvement
- 8.** They were working as usually.
 (a) usual
 (b) as usual
 (c) usually
 (d) No improvement
- 9.** He is unlikely to come to the party. But if he comes I would talk to him.
 (a) if he would come
 (b) if he is to come
 (c) if he will come
 (d) No improvement
- 10.** The passengers have formed a queue at the booking- counter much before a train arrives.
 (a) formed
 (b) have been forming
 (c) form
 (d) No improvement
- 11.** You must complete this work up to Sunday.
 (a) within Sunday
 (b) by Sunday
 (c) until Sunday
 (d) No improvement
- 12.** If it will rain the match will be abandoned.
 (a) If it rains
 (b) If it would rain
 (c) If it rained
 (d) No improvement

13. How long do you think Mr Kamal knew John?
 (a) will know (b) knows
 (c) has known (d) No improvement

14. I have still to meet a person who is perfectly satisfied with his job.
 (a) am still to meet
 (b) am yet to meet
 (c) might still meet
 (d) No improvement

2013 (I)

15. She told the children not to stop the work.
 (a) not stopping
 (b) don't stop
 (c) not stopping of
 (d) No improvement
16. I am not telling that you should hunt out people to pursue your policies.
 (a) asking (b) saying
 (c) speaking (d) No improvement
17. He succeeded by dint of hard work.
 (a) by means of (b) by doing
 (c) by virtue of (d) No improvement
18. You have read that book for ages.
 (a) have been reading
 (b) had read
 (c) will be reading
 (d) No improvement
19. The only bit of relief for the victims has been the increase in compensation.
 (a) were
 (b) have been
 (c) was that they were given
 (d) No improvement
20. He is resembling his father.
 (a) has been resembling
 (b) resembles like
 (c) resembles
 (d) No improvement
21. I am not sure why she is wanting to see him.
 (a) she wants (b) does she want
 (c) is she wanting (d) No improvement
22. Everybody who finished writing can go home.
 (a) had finished (b) have finished
 (c) has finished (d) No improvement
23. I wish I can sing as well as you do.
 (a) do (b) could
 (c) did (d) No improvement

24. It has been two years since I have seen him last.

- (a) when I have seen him
 (b) since I had seen him
 (c) since I saw him
 (d) No improvement
25. My neighbour is having two cars.
 (a) is owning (b) has
 (c) is possessing (d) No improvement
26. His flute recitation was highly appreciated.
 (a) flute recital (b) flute play
 (c) flute singing (d) No improvement
27. She must try at making him understand.
 (a) to make him to understand
 (b) to make him understand
 (c) to make his understanding
 (d) No improvement
28. These are your new shoes, aren't they?
 (a) isn't it? (b) is it so?
 (c) are they? (d) No improvement
29. He told to us everything he knew.
 (a) us everything he knew
 (b) us everything he is knowing
 (c) us everything he was knowing
 (d) No improvement
30. Unless you do not work hard, you won't succeed in life.
 (a) cannot work hard
 (b) will not work hard
 (c) work hard
 (d) No improvement
31. As I am tired, I cannot be able to climb this hill now.
 (a) can be able
 (b) will not be able
 (c) will not be possible
 (d) No improvement
32. I should not spend money for luxuries.
 (a) on luxuries
 (b) in luxuries
 (c) through luxuries
 (d) No improvement
33. On being asked by the judge if he had murdered his wife the accused denied the charge.
 (a) refused (b) rebutted
 (c) contradicted (d) No improvement
34. The new headmaster affected many changes in the school.
 (a) injected (b) effected
 (c) inflicted (d) No improvement

2014 (I)

35. There is no rain in our village for the last six months.
 (a) has been
 (b) was
 (c) had been
 (d) No improvement
36. The police investigated into the matter.
 (a) with the matter
 (b) at the matter
 (c) the matter
 (d) No improvement
37. Ramachandra Murthy and his family is in Guyana from 1985.
 (a) since
 (b) about
 (c) on
 (d) No improvement
38. I am living in this town since 1980.
 (a) was living
 (b) shall live
 (c) have been living
 (d) No improvement
39. If I was you I should tell him the truth.
 (a) am you
 (b) were you
 (c) had been you
 (d) No improvement
40. He is better than any boy in the class.
 (a) any boys
 (b) all the boys
 (c) any other boy
 (d) No improvement
41. Anil ought not to tell me your secret, but he did.
 (a) to be telling
 (b) tell
 (c) to have told
 (d) No improvement
42. If I were him I would have not accepted the offer.
 (a) If I was him
 (b) If I were he
 (c) If I had he
 (d) No improvement
43. What the nation needs is people of character.
 (a) are the people of character
 (b) are people of character
 (c) is a people of character
 (d) No improvement

44. We now come to the important question of where this great swarm of galaxies have come from.

- (a) have come
- (b) has come from
- (c) are coming from
- (d) No improvement

45. Fewer rainfall means less traffic accidents, according to the experts' report on highway safety.

- (a) Less rainfall means fewer traffic accidents
- (b) Less rainfall means less traffic accidents
- (c) Fewer rainfall means fewer traffic accidents
- (d) No improvement

46. I never saw you at the party yesterday.

- (a) have not seen
- (b) did not see
- (c) had never seen
- (d) No improvement

47. Ajeet is a bigger scholar than his brother.

- (a) better
- (b) smaller
- (c) superior
- (d) No improvement

48. I did not wait for him because he went out before I arrived.

- (a) has gone out
- (b) had gone out
- (c) had been out
- (d) No improvement

49. Whenever I saw him, he has been reading the same novel.

- (a) had been reading
- (b) read
- (c) was reading
- (d) No improvement

50. Since, the beginning of the term, we are spending a lot of time on poetry.

- (a) spent
- (b) will spend
- (c) have spent
- (d) No improvement

51. Your sister cooks well, isn't she?

- (a) isn't it?
- (b) doesn't she?
- (c) doesn't it?
- (d) No improvement

52. Dickens' novels, like many writers, are largely autobiographical.

- (a) like those of many other writers
- (b) like so many others
- (c) like many other novelists
- (d) No improvement

53. She was as pretty as, if not prettier than, any other girl at the party.

- (a) She was very pretty
- (b) She was pretty
- (c) She was the prettiest
- (d) No improvement

54. Never I have seen such breathtaking scenery!

- (a) Never have I
- (b) Ever I have
- (c) I cannot ever
- (d) No improvement

2014 (II)

55. I never have and probably never will write good letters.

- (a) I never have written
- (b) I never have wrote
- (c) I never have been writing
- (d) No improvement

56. I think his feet are bigger than any boy in town.

- (a) his feet are bigger than many boys in town
- (b) his feet are bigger than no boys in town
- (c) his feet are bigger than any other boy in town
- (d) No improvement

57. I haven't hardly studied for this examination.

- (a) Hardly I have studied
- (b) I have hardly studied
- (c) Not hardly I have studied
- (d) No improvement

58. As you look across the street, lighted windows can be seen.

- (a) you saw lighted windows
- (b) lighted windows may be seen
- (c) you can see lighted windows
- (d) No improvement

59. Her sister is a nurse and she intends to be one too.

- (a) this is the profession she intends
- (b) her intention is the same profession
- (c) she intending to be a nurse too
- (d) No improvement

60. He asked for the cup of tea.

- (a) some cup of tea
- (b) cup of tea
- (c) a cup of tea
- (d) No improvement

61. Several people saw the thief snatch her gold chain.

- (a) people have seen
- (b) people were seeing
- (c) people must see
- (d) No improvement

62. We shall not wait for anyone who will arrive late.

- (a) who arrives late
- (b) who arrived late
- (c) who shall arrive
- (d) No improvement

63. We had a hard time in the war.

- (a) from the war
- (b) since the war
- (c) during the war
- (d) No improvement

64. He aimed a blow on me.

- (a) at me
- (b) to me
- (c) against me
- (d) No improvement

65. He waited for her by dinner time.

- (a) at dinner time
- (b) till dinner time
- (c) on dinner time
- (d) No improvement

66. He does not have the last idea of it.

- (a) little
- (b) less
- (c) least
- (d) No improvement

67. Born of poor, illiterate farm workers, Lincoln rose to become the President of the USA.

- (a) raised to become
- (b) arose to become
- (c) risen to become
- (d) No improvement

68. Gopal is two years older than his brother.

- (a) than own brother
- (b) to his brother
- (c) by his brother
- (d) No improvement

69. The editor regretted that he was unable to make use of the article.

- (a) was disabled
- (b) was unable
- (c) was enabled
- (d) No improvement

70. He walked softly lest he may wake the baby.

- (a) he would wake
- (b) he waked
- (c) he should wake
- (d) No improvement

71. I look forward to meet you in Delhi.

- (a) to meeting you
- (b) to meet with you
- (c) at meeting you
- (d) No improvement

72. I do not know where has he gone.

- (a) where had he gone
- (b) where he has gone
- (c) when has he gone
- (d) No improvement

73. The teacher taught the students that the moon goes round the earth.

- (a) the moon went round the earth
- (b) the moon is going round the earth
- (c) the moon has gone round the earth
- (d) No improvement

74. This is the boy that I talked to you about.

- (a) who I talked to you about
- (b) whom I talked to you about
- (c) which I talked to you about
- (d) No improvement

2015 (I)

75. We need honest workers, not people of redoubtable integrity.

- (a) doubting
- (b) doubtful
- (c) doubtless
- (d) No improvement

76. I expect every player here to be conversant at the rules of game.

- (a) on
- (b) about
- (c) with
- (d) No improvement

77. There is no alternate, so we must leave now.

- (a) altering
- (b) alternative
- (c) alternation
- (d) No improvement

78. If I were you, I would do it at once.

- (a) was
- (b) am
- (c) would be
- (d) No improvement

79. They set a strong guard, lest anyone could escape.

- (a) would
- (b) might
- (c) should
- (d) No improvement

80. The matter called up an explanation of his conduct.

- (a) out
- (b) in
- (c) for
- (d) No improvement

81. The accused refused having murdered anybody.

- (a) disagreed
- (b) denied
- (c) declaimed
- (d) No improvement

82. We cannot trust a man who plays false and loose with others.

- (a) false or loose
- (b) fast or loose
- (c) fast and loose
- (d) No improvement

83. He is still in vigorous health although he is on the right side of sixty.

- (a) wrong
- (b) left
- (c) negative
- (d) No improvement

84. Any English are known for their practical instincts.

- (a) Some
- (b) Many
- (c) The
- (d) No improvement

85. Fifty miles are a long distance to walk.

- (a) is
- (b) become
- (c) be
- (d) No improvement

86. Economics today were not what it was a century ago.

- (a) are
- (b) was
- (c) is
- (d) No improvement

87. Hearing the news of the accident, he broke.

- (a) broke down
- (b) broke up
- (c) broke out
- (d) No improvement

88. The speaker asked the audience to bear upon him for a few minutes more.

- (a) on
- (b) with
- (c) for
- (d) No improvement

89. Those men who are false to their friends should be avoided.

- (a) The men
- (b) Men
- (c) Such men
- (d) No improvement

90. Many people find it difficult to make both hands meet.

- (a) both accounts
- (b) both hands to mouth
- (c) both ends meet
- (d) No improvement

91. Young children are not physically capable to carry these loads.

- (a) have to carry these loads
- (b) of carrying these loads
- (c) carry these loads
- (d) No improvement

92. I enjoyed the ballet by a troupe of Russian dancers.

- (a) troop
- (b) trouper
- (c) trooper
- (d) No improvement

93. The secretary threatened to resign his post.

- (a) from his post
- (b) to his post
- (c) for his post
- (d) No improvement

94. By the time he arrived, everybody had gone home.

- (a) when he arrived
- (b) at which he arrived
- (c) by which he arrive
- (d) No improvement

2015 (II)

95. It's ten o'clock already. It's high time you went home.

- (a) you had gone
- (b) you were going
- (c) you had been
- (d) No improvement

96. The students are playing volleyball since 8 am.

- (a) were playing
- (b) have playing
- (c) have been playing
- (d) No improvement

97. Our plans for the trip fell down because we had no money.

- (a) off
- (b) out
- (c) through
- (d) No improvement

98. None of these groups has reported accurately on the prevailing situation.

- (a) have reported
- (b) was reported
- (c) has reporting
- (d) No improvement

99. Among the athletes undergoing training Ramesh was easily the better.

- (a) best
- (b) better
- (c) the best
- (d) No improvement

100. The earth moves round the Sun, isn't it?

- (a) wasn't it?
- (b) hasn't it?
- (c) doesn't it?
- (d) No improvement

101. Supposing if he is arrested what will he do?

- (a) if he will be arrested
- (b) he is arrested
- (c) if he was arrested
- (d) No improvement

- 102.** My students have been interesting in learning French.
 (a) have been interested
 (b) are being interesting
 (c) have also interesting
 (d) No improvement
- 103.** Hardly I had fallen asleep, when the bell rang.
 (a) I was fallen (b) had I fallen
 (c) I fell asleep (d) No improvement
- 104.** These days, Radha finds it difficult to make both her ends meet.
 (a) both ends meet
 (b) both the ends meet
 (c) ends meet
 (d) No improvement
- 105.** My mother always asks us to close the fan when we leave the room.
 (a) on the fan (b) off the fans
 (c) turn off the fan (d) No improvement
- 106.** If she does not get more high salary, she will resign.
 (a) more higher salary
 (b) high salaries
 (c) a higher salary
 (d) No improvement
- 107.** The parents should not discriminate from the girl child.
 (a) discriminate between
 (b) discriminate against
 (c) discriminate at
 (d) No improvement
- 108.** Shakespeare's play 'Macbeth' is another of his greatest works.
 (a) one of his greatest
 (b) best of his greatest
 (c) greatest of his
 (d) No improvement
- 109.** Some schools require children to wear black leather expensive shoes.
 (a) black expensive leather shoes
 (b) expensive leather black shoes
 (c) expensive black leather shoes
 (d) No improvement
- 110.** It is a good thing for him should recognise his faults.
 (a) that he to recognise his faults
 (b) him recognising his faults
 (c) for him to recognise his faults
 (d) No improvement
- 111.** Some boys speak their mother-tongue among one another.
 (a) between them
 (b) among themselves
 (c) with them
 (d) No improvement
- 112.** Prior than taking any decisions he always consults his lawyer.
 (a) Prior to
 (b) Previous to
 (c) Prior as
 (d) No improvement
- 113.** He does not know what the university is.
 (a) an (b) a
 (c) one (d) No improvement
- 114.** The Prime Minister called on the President.
 (a) by (b) in
 (c) to (d) No improvement
- 115.** No sooner did we reach the railway station when it began to rain.
 (a) than (b) and
 (c) while (d) No improvement
- 116.** Well-bred children always listen to their parents' advice.
 (a) hear to (b) agree
 (c) obey (d) No improvement
- 117.** We had not met since then, neither did I wish to meet him now.
 (a) never did I wish
 (b) nor did I wish
 (c) did not I wish
 (d) No improvement
- 118.** Even she had taken a taxi, she would have been late.
 (a) Even if she had
 (b) Although she had
 (c) As if she had
 (d) No improvement
- 119.** He felt sure of his success, though he was beginning to get worried.
 (a) his succeed
 (b) his successes
 (c) being succeeded
 (d) No improvement
- 2016 (I)**
- 120.** The police accused him for theft.
 (a) with (b) in
 (c) of (d) No improvement
- 121.** He wanted that I left immediately.
 (a) I may leave
 (b) me to leave
 (c) I leave
 (d) No improvement
- 122.** This is to certify that I know Mr J Mathews since 1970.
 (a) am knowing
 (b) had known
 (c) have known
 (d) No improvement
- 123.** They took away everything that belonged to him.
 (a) that had been belonging
 (b) that belong
 (c) that has been belonging
 (d) No improvement
- 124.** It was the mother of the girl of whose voice I had recognised.
 (a) whose voice
 (b) the voice of who
 (c) voice whose
 (d) No improvement
- 125.** The Executive Council is consisted of ten members.
 (a) consists of
 (b) comprises of
 (c) constituted of
 (d) No improvement
- 126.** The maid was laying the table for dinner.
 (a) setting up
 (b) lying
 (c) sorting out
 (d) No improvement
- 127.** We have so arranged the matters and one of us is always on duty.
 (a) that one of us
 (b) so that one of us
 (c) such that one of us
 (d) No improvement
- 128.** Hardly had we got into the forest when it began to rain.
 (a) Hardly we got
 (b) We had hardly got
 (c) We had got hard
 (d) No improvement
- 129.** Each time he felt tired he lied down.
 (a) lies
 (b) lays
 (c) lay
 (d) No improvement
- 130.** Though it was raining, but I went out.
 (a) but yet I
 (b) I
 (c) however I
 (d) No improvement